

SGSU Executive Exit Reports: 2024-2025

President (KC Tsiolis): As President, I oversaw the SGSU's activities during the 2024-2025 academic year. I had the joy of working with an incredible executive team to deliver a variety of academic and social events to bring our graduate community closer together. I personally led the organization of several events, including Game Nights and the NSERC CGRS D Workshop. Most notably, I was the lead organizer of this year's edition of Statistics Graduate Student Research Day, an event held at the end of the winter semester to showcase the tremendous work done by graduate students in our department and to network with students from other departments and universities. I managed both the emails to student listservs and our graduate student Slack workspace to advertise events and key upcoming academic deadlines (e.g., major scholarship applications). I served as the main point of contact between the MSc and PhD students and the department administration. I met regularly with the Chair and Director to discuss student concerns, and I relayed messages from the department back to the students. I also represented my peers at department meetings throughout the academic year.

Vice President, Internal (Elijah French):

As Vice-President, Internal, my main role was to act as the student body's representative in the UTGSU. In this role I attended three UTGSU assembly meetings, took notes on these meetings, and relayed important information from these meetings to the rest of the SGSU. I also coordinated the use of the UTGSU gym for two separate volleyball events. I organized the attendance of the GSU's health plan representative at the 2025 orientation event. Where she gave valuable information about the Greenshield plan and other benefits graduate students are entitled. On top of this, I helped out the planning and execution of several events throughout the year including two game nights.

Vice President, Events (Bernard Miskic):

As Vice-President of Events, I worked alongside KC to brainstorm, plan, and execute department events throughout the school year. Most of these were social gatherings designed to strengthen the sense of community within the Department of Statistics. Among the events I organized were Secret Santa and the annual Pub Night. While many events were relatively straightforward to plan, Pub Night presented unique challenges, ranging from logistical issues with bookings to navigating the administrative "politics" involved in hosting an event with alcohol. Despite these hurdles, the year's events were successful, and I believe KC and I collaborated effectively to deliver memorable experiences for our peers.

Vice President, Academic (Mandy Yao):

As Vice-President, Academic, I organized events for students to develop their research and academic skills. Specifically, I helped to organize a workshop to encourage and aid students in applying to the Ontario Graduate Scholarship (OGS), and the annual SGSU Research Day. I also helped out with various social events that the SGSU has organized and attended meetings with the admin and chair of the department. As the previous President of the SGSU, I tried my best to relay my knowledge and experience from the previous year to make things a bit easier or more effective this year.

Secretary (Luis Sierra Muntane):

As the secretary, I was in charge of maintaining and updating the website, adding photographs from the various SGSU events as well as keeping other relevant information up to date. Another responsibility is that of taking minutes at SGSU meetings and making them available on the website, as well as attending meetings with the department's admin and chair, keeping a record of key decisions that impact the students. I also provided general support at organizing SGSU activities.

Treasurer (Pak Hop Chan):

In 2024-2025, the SGSU received \$2,170.90 from the UTGSU in head grant payments, an 14% increase compared to last year. By the end of September, we spent a total of \$3,026.48 on various events throughout the year, funding social events like Pub night, various games and movie nights, and holiday celebrations. This is a 23% increase compared to the past year. We operated at a loss of \$855.58 (the loss for the previous year was \$554.51), as intended since the SGSU has been operating at a surplus for several years. Note that the figures for last year included expenses for two park days for a total of \$487.18. Our closing balance in our bank account is \$5,003.83. I also organised the first ping pong tournament in SGSU.

First Year Representative (Leo Watson):

As first-year representative, I served as the bridge between the first-year Ph.D. students and SGSU to ensure a smooth integration process for the new cohort. This included working with other executive members to ensure events did not conflict with first-year commitments, heavily advertising the events to the cohort, and bringing forth the concerns of first-years to the SGSU and, more broadly, the department.

MSc Representative (Bushra Haque):

As MSc representative, my main role was to liaise between the master's students and the SGSU, making sure their voices were heard by both the executive team and the department. I brought forward ideas to strengthen the community within the MSc cohort and within the larger department, and I advocated for improved access to desk space. I also actively shared updates and upcoming events with students to encourage participation. In addition, I led many social initiatives, such as organizing treats for departmental celebrations, and helped out with other SGSU events such as game nights. I was also part of the Research Day planning committee and championed the organization of the Research Day reception.